Knowledge organiser for eyewitness evidence

Tuesday 19 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 1 Week 3 | HUM-LAUNCH-S1-W03

White paper version. Read quietly, point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe. You may pass. No public answer or reading aloud is required.

Learning outcome: Evaluate survivor testimony (curated online archive).

Historians ask who made an account, when it was recorded and why. They consider what the witness could know, the time since the event and other evidence. They judge what a source is useful for, with clear limits. This pack contains no survivor testimony or imagery.

Check	What to ask
Who	Who witnessed the event? Who recorded or edited the account? What could each know?
When recorded	Keep the event date and recording date separate. How long was the gap?
Purpose	Why was it made, for whom, and in response to which question?
Memory and time	What is clear, uncertain or outside the witness's view? Time matters, but later does not mean false.
Corroboration	Compare a specific claim with evidence from a separate origin. Check documents too.
Use and limits	What can this account help us understand? What cannot it establish alone?

Careful conclusions

An account can be useful for one question and limited for another. A repeated claim is not a new witness. A plan does not prove a result. Documents also have makers, purposes and limits.

Survivor testimony matters for individual voice and perspective, remembrance and learning. No account is supplied here. Use general questions, dignity and careful checking.

You may pass or use the agreed supervised pause. The everyday fiction is not a comparison with Holocaust experiences.